All Fives - Convention Card

Every 1-level suit opening promises 5+ cards (with known exceptions).

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

Openings

1NT

- **1st/2nd** - 12-14 HCP, balanced (4333/4432/5332 incl. 5M) -

Responses to 1NT

- **2♣** - Split Stayman - 4-card major ask (inv+). Crawling: weak 4-4 majors
- **2♦** - 5-card major ask (inv+, 8+ HCP). Artificial 2♥ denial
- **2♥** - Natural, to play (weak, 5+ ♥)
- **2♠** - Natural, to play (weak, 5+ ♠)
- **2NT** - Natural invitation (no 4M, no 5M)
- **3♣** - 5-5 minors, slam interest
- **3♦** - 5-5 majors, GF
- **3♥** - Splinter - short ♥, 5-4+ minors, slam interest
- **3♠** - Splinter - short ♠, 5-4+ minors, slam interest

Split Stayman (2♣) Continuations

- **2♦** - No 4M (denial)
- **2♥** - 4+ hearts (may also have 4 spades)
- **2♠** - 4 spades, not 4 hearts

After 2♦ denial:

- **pass** - Weak, no 4M (drop)
- **2♥** - Crawling - weak 4-4 majors. Opener passes or corrects to 2♠
- **2NT** - Invitational, no 4M
- **3♥** - Smolen - 5♠ + 4♥, GF (right-sides 5-3 ♠ fit)
- **3♠** - Smolen - 5♥ + 4♠, GF (right-sides 5-3 ♥ fit)
- **3NT** - Game values, no 4M

5-Card Major Ask (2♦) Continuations

- **2♥** - No 5M (artificial denial - keeps 2NT free for invite)
- **2♠** - 5 spades
- **2NT** - 5 hearts

Escaping 1NTx - Helvic Wriggle

- **XX** - One-suited (opener bids 2♣, pass or correct)
- **2♣** - ♣+♦ (touching)
- **2♦** - ♦+♥ (touching)
- **2♥** - ♥+♠ (touching)
- **Pass** - To play / later
- **Delayed XX** - Non-touching (♣+♥ or ♦+♠)
- **10+ HCP** - Pass for penalty

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

1-Level Suits

- **1st/2nd** - 12+ HCP (~7 losers)
- **3rd** - 8+ HCP (light, tactical). Best minor: 1♣ may be 3, 1♦ may be 3. 1♥/1♠ strict 5+.

- **1C** - 4+ clubs (1st/2nd: 4 only with 15+ bal 3334. 3rd/4th: 3+ best minor)
- **1D** - 4+ diamonds (1st/2nd). 3+ diamonds (3rd/4th best minor)
- **1H** - 5+ hearts (may be 4: 4333 with 15+ bal in 1st/2nd only. 3rd/4th: strict 5+)
- **1S** - 5+ spades (may be 4: 4333 or 4-4 majors in 1st/2nd. 3rd/4th: strict 5+)

- 4-4 majors with 4+ minor: open the minor, show majors naturally
- 4-4 majors, no 4+ minor (15 HCP 1st/2nd): open 1♠, bid 2♥ next
- 4-4 majors, no 4+ minor (3rd/4th 12-14): open 1♣ (best minor)
- 4-4 majors, no 4+ minor (1st/2nd, 16-17): open 1♠, rebid 2NT
- 4-4 majors, no 4+ minor (3rd/4th, 15-17): open 1NT
- 4333 with 15+ bal: open the 4-card suit, rebid 2NT
- 2NT rebid = balanced (opening suit may be only 4)

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

2♣ - Benji

- **type 1** - 22-23 bal (2♣-2♦-2NT)
- **type 2** - Strong major, ~5 losers, 5+ suit, 3 top honours (2♣-2♦-2♥/2♠)

Responses to 2♣

- **2♦** - Waiting (0-7)
- **2♥** - Positive relay, balanced, no 5-card suit, 8+
- **2♠** - 5+ spades, 8+ (GF)
- **2NT** - 5+ hearts, 8+ (GF, swapped with 2♠)
- **3♣/3♦** - 5+ minor, GF, slam interest

2♦ - Strong Game-Force

Controls: A=2, K=1

- **2♥** - 0-1

- **2♠** - 2
- **2NT** - 3
- **3♣** - 4
- **3♦** - 5
- **3♥** - 6

2♥ / 2♠ - Weak Two

6-10 HCP, 6+ cards, 2+ of top 5 honours
Style: Disciplined, especially vulnerable
Avoid: Void or strong 4-card side suit

Ogust (2NT asks)

- **3♣** - Min, poor suit
- **3♦** - Min, good suit
- **3♥** - Max, poor suit
- **3♠** - Max, good suit
- **3NT** - Solid (AKQxxx+)

After Ogust

- **3M** - Sign-off
- **new suit 3** - Forcing
- **3NT** - To play
- **4M** - To play
- **new suit 4** - Cue-bid, slam try

Interference (DOPI)

- **XX** - = 3♣ (min/poor)
- **Pass** - = 3♦ (min/good)
- **overcall** - Ogust off, natural

2NT - 20-21, balanced

- **3♣** - Puppet Stayman
- **3♦** - Transfer to ♥
- **3♥** - Transfer to ♠
- **4NT** - Quantitative (invite 6NT)

Preempts

- **3x** - 7+ cards, ~5-10 HCP, 7-8 losers (fav: 8-9, unfav: 7), destructive
- **3NT** - Gambling (AKQxxxx+ minor, no outside A/K)
- **4♥/4♠** - To play (distributional or preemptive)
- **4♣/4♦** - Strong preempt (8+ minor)
- **5♣/5♦** - Extreme preempt or to play

Defensive Bidding

All defensive actions governed by LTC adjusted for vulnerability

- **Favorable (NV vs Vul)** - NV vs Vul - act with 1 more loser than standard
- **Equal** - Both Vul or both NV - standard thresholds
- **Unfavorable (Vul vs NV)** - Vul vs NV - require 1 fewer loser than standard

Overcalls

- **Simple** - 8 losers at equal (9 fav, 7 unfav), 5+ cards, suit quality > HCP
- **Jump** - Weak, 9 losers at equal (10 fav, 8 unfav)
- **Takeout X** - All unbid suits, 6 losers at equal (12+ HCP or any 17+)

RAPTOR

Trigger: 1NT overcall of opponent's suit opening **Shows:** 4 in unbid major + 5+ in a minor, 8 losers (9 fav, 7 unfav)

vs Major Opening

- **cue bid** - Asks major
- **2 other minor** - To play
- **2 unbid major** - Natural 5+
- **2NT** - Invitational+

vs Minor Opening

- **2C cheapest** - Pass or correct
- **cue bid** - Asks major
- **2♥/2♠** - Natural 5+
- **2NT** - Invitational+

CRASH over artificial/strong openings

Trigger: Opponents open artificial/strong or short/garbage (strong 1♣, 2♣, 2♦, short ♣ 2+, garbage 1♦). NOT Multi 2♦.

- **Color** - Two same-color suits (♥+♦ reds or ♠+♣ blacks)
- **Rank** - Two same-rank suits (♥+♠ majors or ♣+♦ minors)
- **Shape** - Two same-shape suits (♠+♦ pointed or ♥+♣ rounded)

vs Strong 2♣

- **X** - Color
- **2♦** - Rank
- **2♥/2♠** - Natural 5+
- **2NT** - Shape

vs Strong 1♣

- **X** - Color
- **1♦** - Rank
- **1♥/1♠** - Natural 5+
- **1NT** - Shape

Vs strong/garbage 2♦ (NOT Multi)

- **X** - Color
- **2♥** - Rank
- **2♠** - Natural 5+
- **2NT** - Shape

Vs garbage/short 1♦

- **X** - Color
- **1♥** - Rank
- **1♠** - Natural 5+
- **1NT** - Shape

Requirements: 5-4+ shape (5-5+ unfav), LTC: 8 equal / 9 fav / 7 unfav

Advancer: Pass/correct - bid better suit in the shorter possible pair

CRASH defense to 1NT (differentiated by strength)

Vs strong NT (15-17)

- **X** - Color
- **2♣** - Rank
- **2♦** - Shape
- **2♥/2♠** - Natural 5+

Vs weak NT (12-14)

- **X** - Penalty (15+)
- **2♣** - Color
- **2♦** - Rank
- **2♥/2♠** - Natural 5+
- **2NT** - Shape

After penalty X: If opponents run: revert to natural bidding

Michaels Cuebid

- **(1m) - 2m** - Both majors (5-5+)
- **(1M) - 2M** - Other major + unspecified minor (2NT/3♣ asks which)

Unusual 2NT

Shows: Two lowest unbid suits (5-5+)

Lebensohl after double of weak two

- **2NT** - Relay to 3♣ (weak hand, pass or correct)
- **direct 3 level** - Invitational (8-11 HCP)
- **cuebid** - Game-forcing, asks stopper
- **slow shows fast denies** - Via 2NT then 3NT = stopper; direct 3NT = no stopper

Defense to Multi 2♦ (Fighters style)

Trigger: Opponent opens Multi 2♦ (weak two in either major). CRASH excluded.

- **X** - 12-15 balanced OR any 19+
- **2♥/2♠** - Natural, 5+ suit, 10+ HCP
- **2NT** - 16-18 balanced (systems on)
- **3 level** - Natural, good suit, constructive
- **Pass** - Default (most hands)

After suit revealed: Treat as standard weak two: X = takeout, Lebensohl applies

Defense to 5-5 openings

Trigger: Opponent opens 2♥ (5♥ + 5m) or 2♠ (5♠ + 5m)

Standard weak-two defense of the bid major

- **X** - Takeout of bid major, Lebensohl applies
- **2NT** - 16-18 balanced (systems on)
- **new suit** - Natural, constructive
- **cuebid** - Game-forcing, stopper ask

Opener has 5-card minor - bid minors cautiously

Defense to 3-level preempts

Trigger: Opponent opens 3♣ / 3♦ / 3♥ / 3♠

- **X** - Takeout/cooperative (bid with shape, pass with flat defence)
- **3NT** - To play (stopper required)
- **new suit 3** - Forcing, natural
- **new suit 4** - To play (not forcing)
- **4NT** - Unusual (two lowest unbid suits)

Lebensohl does NOT apply (already at 3-level)

Defense to 4-level preempts

Trigger: Opponent opens 4♣ / 4♦ / 4♥ / 4♠

- **X of major** - Penalty-oriented (pass unless very distributional)
- **X of minor** - Takeout (room to find major fit)
- **4NT** - Two-suited takeout
- **5 level** - To play

Balancing (protection)

Trigger: Opponent's bidding dies at low level: (1x)-P-P-?

Act ~3 HCP less than direct ('borrow a king from partner')

- **1NT** - ~11-14 (not 15-18)
- **X** - 10+ (not 12+)
- **overcall** - 8+, reasonable suit
- **jump overcall** - Intermediate (not weak)

Partner downgrades ~3 HCP ('return the borrowed king')

Advancing partner's overcall

Trigger: (1x) - 1y/2y [partner overcalls] - ?

- **simple raise** - Competitive 6-9, 3+ support (NOT invitational)
- **cuebid** - Limit raise+ (10+, 3+ support)
- **jump raise** - Preemptive (weak, 4+ support, NOT invitational)
- **2NT** - Sound raise (9-11, 3+ support)
- **new suit** - Non-forcing (constructive)
- **jump new suit** - Fit-showing (good suit + support, invitational)

Advancing partner's takeout X (of 1-level)

Trigger: (1x) - X - Pass - ?

- **cheapest suit** - Minimum (0-8), forced
- **jump suit** - Invitational (9-11)
- **cuebid** - Game force (12+)
- **1NT** - 6-10 with stopper
- **2NT** - 11-12 with stopper (invitational)
- **pass** - Penalty conversion (rare - 5+ strong trumps in opener's suit)

Lead-directing doubles

X of any artificial bid = lead that suit

- **X Stayman** - Lead clubs
- **X transfer** - Lead the suit doubled (not target major)
- **X cuebid** - Lead that suit
- **Lightner** - X of slam = unusual lead (NOT normal lead)

Defense to opponents' transfers over 1NT

Trigger: (1NT) - P - (transfer) - ?

- **X** - Lead-directing (the transfer suit, not target)
- **bid transfer suit** - Natural (you hold that suit)
- **bid target suit** - Takeout/lead-directing

Sandwich position

Trigger: (1x) - P - (1y) - ? [between two bidders]

- **X** - Both unbid suits, moderate values
- **1NT** - Unusual (two lower unbid, NOT natural)
- **overcall** - Natural, good suit required

Dangerous position - only act with shape or genuine strength

Defensive Carding

Use your head first. Signals are a last resort.

Signal Selection

Partner need: Ace lead → count. Dummy threatens → count. Shift question → suit preference. Default → attitude. Trumps → suit preference (TSP). **Card cost:** Cheapest card that conveys the message. Never signal with a trick. **Adversarial cost:** FREE signal = declarer already knows (bid suit count, obvious shift, overcalled suit). COSTLY signal = declarer gains info (unbid suit count, ambiguous attitude, critical guess). Prefer free. Costly only when defensive gain outweighs declarer gain.

Attitude

- **Low** - encourage
- **High** - discourage

Obvious Shift (trick 1): Trick 1: attitude refers to the obvious shift suit (dummy's shortest side suit, ≤1 honor, excluding trump/led/declarer's suits; vs NT = shortest). Encourage = continue (no shift tolerance). Discourage = wants the obvious shift. FREE signal.

Count

- **High** - even
- **Low** - odd

Smith Echo (vs NT)

When: vs NT only, trick 2+, following to declarer's suit

- **High** - Don't like it (switch)
- **Low** - Like the opening lead suit (continue)

Adversarial cost: FREE

Exception: *Count overrides when dummy has entryless long suit*

Trump Signals

- **High-low** - Prefer higher-ranking side suit (TSP)
- **Low-high** - Prefer lower-ranking side suit (TSP)

Caution: *Never signal with potential trump tricks (Qxx)*

Italian Style (on discards)

- **Odd card** - Interest in discarded suit
- **Low even** - Interest in lower suit
- **High even** - Interest in higher suit

Discard Discipline

Never signal with potential tricks. Cheapest FREE card (SFS-aware).

Opening Leads

- **Length** - 3rd or 5th highest
- **Sequences** - Top of sequence (AKx→K, KQx→K, QJx→Q, JTx→J, T9x→T)
- **AK** - K lead from AK; A asks for count
- **xx** - Higher
- **xxx** - Lowest (3rd highest)
- **xxxx** - Highest safe, then low
- **With J** - Lead 4th highest (KJ732→3)

Vs suits: Prefer sequences; avoid unsupported honours **Vs NT:** Longest suit unless bidding says opponents hold it

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

Dummy Analysis

Classify dummy's suits → reconstruct declarer from bidding → choose defence line

- **RUNNING THREAT** - 5+ cards, 3+ honours (AKQxx, KQJ9x) - RACE to cash or CUT entries
- **ESTABLISHABLE SOURCE** - 4+ cards, 1-2 honours (KJ84, Q10753) - HOLD UP, attack entries
- **ATTACK TARGET** - ≤3 cards or long without honours (73, xxx) - safe to LEAD
- **ENTRY SUIT** - Contains A or K as side entry - attack to strand long suit
- **TRUMP RUFFING** - Short side suit + trumps = lead trumps to CUT RUFFS

- **1 race** - Running threat + entries → cash winners NOW
- **2 entries** - Establishable source + limited entries → attack entries
- **3 passive** - Flat dummy, no threats → don't break new suits
- **4 cut ruffs** - Singleton + trumps → lead trumps
- **5 force** - You have 4+ trumps → force declarer to ruff, shorten their trumps

Bidding clues:

- 1NT-3NT: Balanced ~25 HCP, no long suit. Lead longest, then passive.
- 1M-2M-4M: Dummy 6-9. Check for singleton. Flat = passive.
- 1M-3M-4M: Dummy 10-12, 4+ trumps. More entries. Be active.
- Weak two-4M: Shape but no tricks. Cash fast.